

F5 Daily Briefing – Wednesday, July 22, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

10

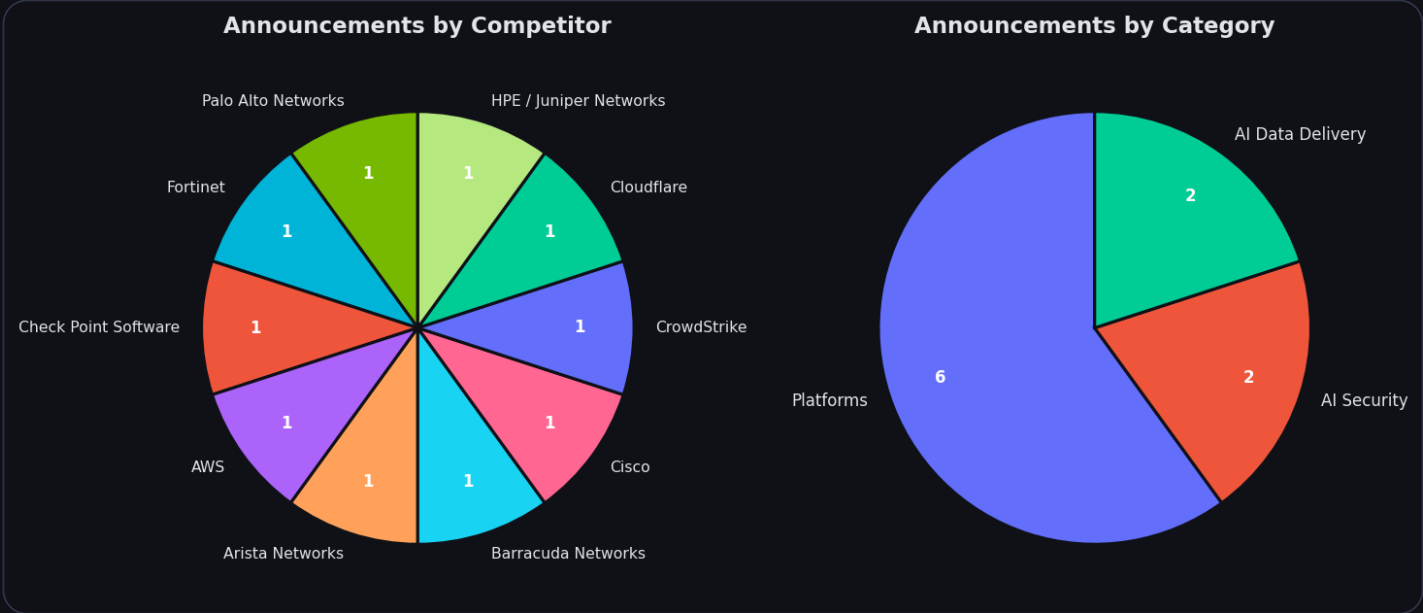
ANNOUNCEMENTS

10

ACTIVE

3

ACTIVE CATEGORIES



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (10)

ACQUISITION

Palo Alto Networks

2026-07-22

Palo Alto Networks to Acquire Observability Provider Embrace

Palo Alto Networks announced plans to acquire Embrace, a Real User Monitoring (RUM) and observability provider for cloud-native environments. The deal adds RUM to Palo Alto's Observability platform and, combined with in-house Synthetics from its ADEM team, expands into Digital Experience Monitoring covering end-user interactions, application validation and backend infrastructure. Following January's \$3.35B Chronosphere acquisition, it signals a continued platform push toward unified end-to-end visibility and automated remediation via Cortex AgentiX. Expected to close in Q1 fiscal 2027; terms undisclosed.

<https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/company/press/2026/palo-alto-networks-to-extend-leading-observability-platform-with-innovative-digital-experience-monitoring>

PARTNERSHIP**Fortinet**

2026-07-22

Fortinet and Intel Collaborate on Security Processor 6 (SP6)

Fortinet and Intel announced a strategic collaboration to co-develop Fortinet's next-generation Security Processor 6 (SP6). The partnership pairs Fortinet's purpose-built ASIC expertise with Intel's design, packaging and manufacturing capabilities to accelerate SP6 development, boost performance for encrypted and AI-related workloads, and strengthen supply-chain resilience and diversification. Fortinet becomes Intel 4's first named external foundry customer, moving from its TSMC-linked supply chain toward a disaggregated, chiplet-based design. The deal advances Fortinet's long-term ASIC roadmap underpinning its firewall differentiation.

<https://www.morningstar.com/news/business-wire/20260721378476/intel-and-fortinet-collaborate-to-advance-cybersecurity-innovation-and-strengthen-global-supply-chain-resilience>

SECURITY ADVISORY**Check Point Software**

2026-07-22

Check Point Issues Jumbo Hotfix for Actively Exploited SmartConsole Auth Bypass (CVE-2026-16232)

Check Point issued a security advisory and July 22 Jumbo Hotfix addressing a critical, actively-exploited authentication bypass (CVE-2026-16232, CVSS 9.3) in Security Management and Multi-Domain Security Management. Attackers can obtain a SmartConsole login token unauthenticated and gain full admin privileges when management is internet-facing without proper Trusted Client restrictions. Additional fixes addressed two administrative command-execution flaws found via BLAST reviews. Check Point urges immediate patching, restricting GUI clients to trusted IPs, and firewall-protecting management access; all Smart-1 Cloud customers are protected.

<https://blog.checkpoint.com/security/security-advisory-action-required-active-exploitation-of-check-point-smartconsole-authentication-bypass-cve-2026-16232/>

PRODUCT UPDATE**AWS**

2026-07-22

AWS Turns Security Hub into an AI and Multicloud Security Control Plane

AWS expanded Security Hub into a unified AI- and multicloud security control plane, extending monitoring to Microsoft Azure alongside AWS and adding protections for AI workloads. New capabilities include GuardDuty AI Protection (targeting abuse and 'cost harvesting'), AI-powered investigations in preview (auto-gathering context, threat intel, confidence scores and MITRE ATT&CK mapping), and an AI inventory cataloging Bedrock models and SageMaker endpoints to assess blast radius. The update positions Security Hub as a single cockpit across clouds and AI, reducing tool sprawl and addressing the growing AI attack surface.

<https://siliconangle.com/2026/07/22/aws-turns-security-hub-ai-multicloud-security-control-plane/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Arista Networks**

2026-07-22

Arista Introduces AI-Driven Edge Threat Management for VeloCloud SD-WAN

Arista Networks announced AI-driven Edge Threat Management (ETM) for its VeloCloud SD-WAN, delivering enterprise-grade zero-trust security at the branch WAN edge on a single platform. ETM combines advanced firewalling, threat prevention, zone-based segmentation, Geo-IP and DNS filtering, and AI-powered policy insights delivered locally. Arista AVA provides policy intelligence with Policy Explainer and Traffic Simulation for plain-language management via VeloCloud Orchestrator. Building on the VeloCloud acquisition, the move expands Arista into SASE, unifying SD-WAN and branch security. Availability is planned for Q4 2026 across VeloCloud hardware and virtual edges.

<https://www.arista.com/en/company/news/press-release/24357-pr-20260721>**PARTNER PROGRAM****Barracuda Networks**

2026-07-22

Barracuda Advances Partner Success Program with New Offerings

Barracuda Networks announced enhancements to its Partner Success Program to help MSPs and channel partners differentiate, scale and grow profitability around the AI-powered BarracudaONE platform. New elements include demand-generation and through-channel marketing automation for co-branded campaigns and syndication, a forthcoming Partner Locator to connect customers with certified partners, and an enhanced partner portal with guided journeys, automation and role-based segmentation to speed activation and co-selling. Barracuda also expanded its Mastery Program with deeper role-based learning, technical labs and advanced sales and technical badges.

<https://www.barracuda.com/company/news/2026/barracuda-advances-partner-success-program>**PRODUCT LAUNCH****Cisco**

2026-07-22

Cisco Introduces Antares Open-Weight AI Models for Vulnerability Localization

Cisco announced Antares, a family of lightweight open-weight security language models that localize likely vulnerabilities inside large code repositories to aid security triage. The Antares-350M and 1B models are available on Hugging Face; the largest 3B model reportedly rivals GPT-5.5 on Cisco's Vloc benchmark while running locally to keep code within an organization's trust boundary. Cisco claims scanning ~500 repos in 15 minutes for under \$1 versus far higher frontier-model costs. Antares outputs ranked candidate files rather than confirmed vulnerabilities or patches, complementing Cisco's Foundry Security and CodeGuard efforts.

<https://blogs.cisco.com/ai/introducing-antares-the-most-efficient-open-weight-ai-models-for-vulnerability-localization>

PARTNERSHIP**CrowdStrike**

2026-07-22

CrowdStrike and Cerebras Partner to Power Falcon AI Detection and Response

CrowdStrike and Cerebras Systems announced a strategic partnership to run Falcon AI Detection and Response (AIDR) models on Cerebras's ultra-fast inference platform, delivering real-time, machine-speed AI security at enterprise scale. In turn, Cerebras will standardize on the CrowdStrike Falcon platform to secure its own AI operations. The collaboration pairs AI-native security with the world's fastest inference to protect data, models, agents and identities, positioning Falcon AIDR as a cornerstone for securing AI as adoption accelerates and every millisecond matters in detecting AI-driven threats.

<https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/press-releases/crowdstrike-cerebras-power-ai-detection-and-response/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cloudflare**

2026-07-22

Cloudflare Launches Monetization Gateway to Charge AI Crawlers for Web Access

Cloudflare introduced a Monetization Gateway that lets websites charge AI crawlers, data agents and model-training systems for access to content, APIs and datasets, turning automated AI traffic into a paid service. A policy shift beginning September 15, 2026 will block AI training crawlers and autonomous agents by default on new ad-supported Cloudflare sites while still allowing traditional search indexers. Mixed-use bots that don't separate indexing from training may be blocked unless explicitly allowed. AWS is pursuing a parallel effort integrating AI traffic monetization into its WAF, signaling a shift toward a programmatic marketplace for AI web access.

<https://sociable.co/business/cloudflare-and-aws-push-for-a-new-payment-model-for-ai-web-access/>

PARTNERSHIP**HPE / Juniper Networks**

2026-07-22

HPE Selected for R&D Projects in U.S. DOE-Led Genesis Mission

HPE announced it was selected for multiple R&D projects within the U.S. Department of Energy-led Genesis Mission to advance AI-driven innovation and scientific discovery. Projects span AI model application, performance optimization, networking, cybersecurity and water availability, including an agentic fusion co-pilot, SwarmSlicer, SciNet, improved long-term weather forecasting, and Spotter-AI for cybersecurity. HPE is also delivering high-performance AI systems for Genesis, including the upcoming Lux supercomputer, in collaboration with AMD and Oak Ridge National Laboratory. The selection reinforces HPE's DOE partnership and its role accelerating sovereign AI and large-scale scientific research.

<https://finance.yahoo.com/technology/ai/articles/hpe-selected-r-d-projects-140000381.html>